

Vivek Valanj

EXTC

Company: Smowcode

Job Profile: Business Development Executive

Offer Type: Internship + Placement

Internship Stipend: 10k first 3 months, 15k next 3 months

CTC: 12 LPA (8 Fixed+2 Variable +2 ESOP)

Location: Andheri, Mumbai

Process Date: 20th-21st November

Placement Process:

Resume Shortlisting

Interview Online(20th)

Interview Offline(21st)

1. Resume Shortlisting

The resume shortlisting round was conducted through a Google Form in which candidates were required to fill in details about their previous experiences, including committee involvement, internships, and key learnings. Shortlisting was done based on the relevance of these experiences to the role, clarity of interest, and overall consistency in the candidate's profile. This round focused more on understanding practical exposure and motivation rather than just academic performance, and the selected candidates were invited for the interview rounds.

2. Online Interview

The second round was an online interview conducted by Adhik, the founder himself. This round was more conversational in nature and aimed at understanding my background, motivation, and alignment with the company and the role. The interview began with my self-introduction, after which the founder explained the product in detail along with its target market. This helped set the context for the discussion and allowed me to understand the business side of the company better.

Following this, I was asked why I was opting for a non-technical role and what I had learned from my previous internship experience, which I had mentioned in the resume shortlisting form. Since my internship was in the marketing domain, I explained how it sparked my interest in business development and sales, and how I enjoyed working closer to customers and strategy. The founder seemed satisfied with my clarity and reasoning. Towards the end of the interview, I was asked about my place of stay and when I would be able to join if selected. The entire interview lasted around 20–25 minutes. A few minutes after the interview concluded, I received a message informing me that there would be another round scheduled offline the following day.

3. **Offline Interview** [No of candidates who appeared for this round - 2]

The third round was an offline interview and was more in-depth and practical compared to the previous rounds. It focused on understanding how I handle pressure, manage multiple responsibilities, and perform in a sales-oriented role. The discussion initially revolved around my previous experiences, especially how I balanced my internship alongside committee work. I answered honestly, mentioning that managing both did disturb my schedule initially, but over time I learned to prioritize tasks better and stay focused despite pressure.

Since the role involved business and sales, I was asked to pitch the company's product to the founder as if I were convincing a potential client. I approached the pitch from a day-to-day usage perspective, explaining how the product could be seamlessly integrated into everyday life while being both beneficial and time-saving for users. I focused on practical use cases rather than just features, which helped demonstrate the product's real-world value. The founder appreciated this approach and was satisfied with how I positioned the product. Towards the end of the interview, I was asked if I had any questions. I used this opportunity to ask about his thoughts on expanding the product into a B2C model, especially targeting students as potential long-term users. He appreciated this forward-thinking approach and showed interest in my perspective. After the interview, I asked for feedback and received a very positive response overall, with one suggestion that I could have shown slightly more energy during the interaction. The interview lasted around 25–30 minutes.

Useful Tips:

What Worked in My Favor

- I had a clear understanding of my past experiences and was able to explain my learnings confidently.
- I demonstrated genuine interest in the **business and sales domain**, backed by relevant internship and committee experience.
- I researched the company and product beforehand, which helped me pitch the product effectively.
- Asking a **thoughtful, future-oriented question** about product expansion showed my interest beyond just the role.
- I maintained honesty throughout the interview, which helped build trust with the interviewer.

Areas Where I Could Have Performed Better

- I could have shown **more energy and enthusiasm**, especially during the offline interview.
- Being slightly more expressive in my tone and body language could have made the interaction even stronger.

Preparation Tips for Future Candidates

- Prepare a strong explanation of **why you are choosing the role/domain**, especially if it is non-technical.
- Research the company, product, and target market thoroughly.
- Always prepare at least **one suggestion or improvement idea** related to the product.
- Practice a basic **sales or product pitch** before the interview.

- Be ready to discuss how you manage pressure and prioritize tasks.

Interview-Day Tips

- Stay calm and confident during the interview.
- Listen carefully to the questions before answering.
- Be honest about challenges and explain how you handled them.
- Ask at least **one meaningful question** at the end of the interview.
- Maintain positive body language and clear communication.

Recommended Resources

- [Business Development – Udemy](#)
- [Product Management 101 – Udemy](#)

For any queries, feel free to contact me via [LinkedIn](#) or on my **mobile number - 8928731857**.

In case of any further doubts, you can refer to the past interview experiences shared by TPO.